

Picture Study





About the Course

Students study art from 1800-1900 through pieces by Edward Bannister, Lilius Trotter, and Vincent Van Gogh. The lesson plans include discussion prompts that tie the artwork to what is being learned in Art Instruction, and other books and resources help students further their relationship with the art studied and consider how art intersects with the large questions of life.

Picture Study

Optional books have been recommended in each term to further the study for high schoolers. They will need to spend time dividing the page count throughout the term on their own in order to determine reading assignments. The recommended books are also good for teacher pre-study to gain knowledge about the art form and/ or artist in order to share information "by the way" with your students.



Placement & Combining Tips

There is one set of lesson plans for students in all grades, which makes this an ideal course to study in a multi-age setting. All lessons begin the same, but extensions increase the length and sophistication of the content.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
1-12	Picture Study 1 time/week 10 min 1 time/week 15 min 1 time/week 20 min 1 time/week 20 min	Our Work: Grades 1-2 Our Work: Grade 3 Our Work: Grades 4-6 Our Work: Grades 7-8 Our Work: Grades 9-12 Art Print Set Redeeming Vision A Passion for the Impossible: The Life of Lilius Trotter Van Gogh

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Picture Study				
				Picture Study



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Picture Study

*Acknowledgement: All Trotter Artwork is used by permission of the Lilius Trotter Legacy and Arab World Ministries of Pioneers

- ☐ Make sure each student has a copy of the artwork included in Our Work for G1-12 and in the Art Print Set.
- ☐ Keep a copy of the artwork you are currently studying on display throughout the weeks of study, only removing it from sight during the memory work lesson. You can remove it from sight by simply turning it over just before beginning that lesson.
- ☐ It is helpful to pre-read biographical information of each artist in full to share with students "by the way." Knowing the information before the students ask the questions is helpful. This way, you can either answer the question directly or help the students know that they will learn the answers as the term progresses. Read the bios directly to your students during lesson times, adding anything you may have learned during your own study of the artist. You can find bios in the lesson links or in Our Work.
- ☐ Before each term, preview the link page which includes links to the Artist biographies and each piece of artwork to be used during the term.
- ☐ Applied Art Questions have been supplied in the Quick Links. These are general questions to be used during Picture Study time as you see fit. The questions can be applied to any artist and artwork. These questions draw in Art Lessons that students study throughout their time of taking those lessons. They help students to connect the skills they are learning in visual arts to what they are observing in Picture Study. Use the questions that are in the level your student is currently taking or has previously taken.
- ☐ HS students read the assigned books throughout the term, where applicable.

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

Picture Study

Optional books have been assigned per term for teacher pre-study.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Picture Study



Our Work: Grades 1-2



Our Work: Grade 3



Our Work: Grades 4-6



Our Work: Grades 7-8



Our Work: Grades 9-12



Art Print Set



Redeeming Vision



A Passion for the Impossible: The Life of Lilius Trotter



Van Gogh



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

∞ [View Supply List Details](#)

Picture Study



Mungyo Soft Pastels



Aerosol Hair Spray



White and Colored Chalk



Quick Links

Picture Study

∞ [Art Print Set](#)

∞ [Appendix: Applied Art Questions](#)

∞ [Foundations \(See Section 5: Art Appreciation and Instruction\)](#)

Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.



Picture Study

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read about the artist ahead of time with the bio provided and share some information about the artist's life with the students.
- Make sure each student has their own copy of the work.



Observe

- Give students time to look closely at the work of art until they are comfortable. They should be able to see the picture in their mind's eye.
- Next, have students discuss observations starting with what is most prominent while looking at the work. Studies show that children benefit from viewing the picture as they discuss it. Students will work on their ability to recall the details by memory in subsequent weeks.
- Lastly, at the end of each picture study lesson if time allows, turn the picture over and have the student describe all that they can recall. This will help to strengthen the memory muscles and to move the memory to long term storage as opposed to short term only.



Discuss

- Continue with a Picture Talk, or natural discussion, using the provided questions in the lesson plans.
- The level of this discussion will be based on the age of the students.
- Optional: There are additional "Applied Art" questions in the Appendix that address concepts such as color, design, and shapes.



Memory Activity

- The second week that you look at a work of art, students will do some kind of memory discussion or drawing as indicated in the lesson plans. It might be a drawing with chalk, modeling with clay, or finding colors with pastels.
- Optional Tip: If students are apprehensive to do a memory drawing, offer a piece of tracing paper and pastel or charcoal for the student to trace over the main lines of the work. Students may feel more empowered at the next memory drawing after tracing once. However, it is okay if students do not feel able to create these memory drawings. Continue to persevere in this way. You are offering students the scaffolding they require in order to grow stronger in their observational skills and in relationship with the artist and their body of work.



Connect

Hang the print in view. Students can record important dates on the Wall Timeline or Book of Centuries. Look for more ideas on the Extra Helpings page.

Picture Study

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 20m Picture Study - Lesson 1

Picture Talk: Edward Mitchell Bannister

📄 Art Print Resource: *Dorchester 1856*
Vocabulary: Linear Perspective, Proportion

→ STUDY

Look at the art quietly for a few minutes; study the work as a whole, then begin to observe details.

∞ Link: Edward Mitchell Bannister Bio

∞ Link: *Dorchester 1856*

→ NARRATE

Still looking at the art, tell all that you notice. Look and listen while others narrate.

→ PICTURE TALK

Edward Mitchell Bannister is an American artist who worked in the Barbizon School style. He painted vast landscapes, often times looking at scenes around him. Bannister painted scenes that were true to life, representing objects as they were. He also painted portraits of people he knew.

Discuss using the questions to strengthen observational skills. Share about the artist's life as opportunities arise.

1. Discuss everything you see in this landscape.
2. Talk about where you may have observed a scene like this before in your own life.
3. What are the people doing in the bottom, right corner?

→ PICTURE INFORMATION

Dorchester 1856 is one of Bannister's earlier paintings. In this painting, he has laid out the scene of a coastal town with boys fishing in the bottom, right corner. There are several boats in the water. Paintings like these sold well for Bannister, as middle-class patrons desired to decorate their homes with scenes of places they loved.

The painting resembles a colonial style of painting with flat colors and idealistic scenes. His houses are all similar. Though Edward already possesses considerable artistic ability, we will notice as we study Bannister's body of work how he grows in his artistic skills, becoming more able to communicate realism in **perspective** and **proportion**.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Edward Mitchell Bannister (November 2, 1828-January 9, 1901) was a Canadian-American oil painter

● VOCABULARY

Perspective: A way of drawing on a two-dimensional surface that portrays the correct depth, width, and height of an object.

∞ Video Link: Perspective

Proportion: refers to the size relationship between objects; for example, your hand is smaller than a horse, and your ear is larger than an ant. Things farther away are smaller, while things closer to you are larger; for example, a chair right next to you will appear larger than a tree that is half a mile down the road.

∞ Video Link: Proportion

WEEK 2 20m Picture Study - Lesson 2

Picture Talk: Edward Mitchell Bannister

📄 Art Print Resource: *Dorchester 1856*
📄 Materials: art book, pastels or watercolors, paper towels, water

→ MEMORY DISCUSSION

Describe the work from memory. What color do you remember most and why?

→ ART APPLICATION

From memory:

Take out your pastels and art books used in art lessons. Have students think about the colors of the painting they have studied. Follow the steps for each grade...

- Levels 1-5: Find the closest color in pastels and tell what they would match in the artwork. For example, a shirt on a boy, or a hat on a fisherman, a sash on a ballerina, a star in the right part of the sky, etc.



Term 1

Find at least two colors.

- Levels 6-12: Mix several color swatches of the colors you remember in your art book. Label them as the object in the painting. For example, a shirt on a boy or a hat on a fisherman, a sash on a ballerina, a star in the right part of the sky, etc.
- Once you are satisfied with your color choices, compare your choice of pastel and swatch to the artwork.

→ EVALUATE

Re-examine print. How did you do?

∞ Link: *Dorchester 1856*

→ PICTURE TALK

If time allows, read about the artist in his bio. You will have time to read more later if needed.

∞ Link: Edward Mitchell Bannister Bio

WEEK 3

20m Picture Study - Lesson 3

Picture Talk: Edward Mitchell Bannister

Art Print Resource: *Newspaper Boy*
Vocabulary: Portrait

→ STUDY

Look at the art quietly for a few minutes; study the work as a whole, then begin to observe details.

∞ Link: *Newspaper Boy*

→ NARRATE

Still looking at the art, tell all that you notice. Look and listen while others narrate.

→ PICTURE TALK

Discuss using questions to strengthen observational skills. Share about the artist's life as opportunities arise.

∞ Link: Edward Mitchell Bannister Bio

1. Discuss everything you see in this portrait.
2. Observe and discuss the color palette.
3. Where is the light source in the portrait? What do you think is the light source?

→ PICTURE INFORMATION

Newspaper boys were a common sight in the 1860s. Bannister paints a **portrait** of this young man. He has elevated what would usually be seen as a poor, destitute child to a young man, dignified in his work. The boy stands tall with newspapers in one hand and his other hand in his pocket, ready to make change for a customer. His clothes appear clean and neat. He has a hat on his head to keep him warm. His gaze seems calm and resolute. All signs of success as opposed to poverty.

A shadow is visible on the left of the painting, the boy's right side, which communicates that he has slowed down for the moment. Usually, these boys were walking up and down city blocks, yelling the headlines in order to drum up business. A still moment was a rarity. This could be another marker of success for this young man in particular.

• VOCABULARY

Portrait: a painting, drawing, or sculpture of a person that captures that person's likeness in physical appearance and personality.

∞ Video Link: Proportion



Term 1

WEEK 4 20m Picture Study - Lesson 4

Picture Talk: Edward Mitchell Bannister

Art Print Resource: *Newspaper Boy*

→ MEMORY DISCUSSION

Describe *Newspaper Boy* from memory.

→ EVALUATE

Re-examine the print. How did you do?

∞ Link: *Newspaper Boy*

→ ART APPLICATION

If you didn't have time in the last lesson to discuss the extra questions, do that now.

→ PICTURE TALK

Read more on the artist in his bio if you didn't finish.

∞ Link: Edward Mitchell Bannister Bio

WEEK 5 20m Picture Study - Lesson 5

Picture Talk: Edward Mitchell Bannister

Art Print Resource: *Untitled (Landscape, Woodcutter on Path)*
Vocabulary: American Barbizon School, Horizon

→ STUDY

Look at the art quietly for a few minutes; study the work as a whole, then begin to observe details.

∞ Link: *Untitled (Landscape, Woodcutter on Path)*

→ NARRATE

Still looking at the art, tell all that you notice. Look and listen while others narrate.

→ PICTURE TALK

Discuss using questions to strengthen observational skills.

1. Discuss everything you see in this landscape.
2. Observe and discuss the color palette.
3. Where do you see the use of **linear perspective** in the painting?
4. Where do you see the use of **atmospheric perspective**?

→ PICTURE INFORMATION

This untitled landscape by Edward Mitchell Bannister was created at the height of Bannister's fame. He is well settled within the **American Barbizon School** at this time. In ten short years, his artistic style and skill have developed immensely!

Further information on the Barbizon School:

∞ Link: Barbizon School

∞ Video Link: American Barbizon School

The subject matter is a woodcutter walking on a path towards a fallen tree. It seems as though someone has cut enough of the fallen tree in order to get by. Maybe he is coming to finish the work of completely cutting the tree up into logs for the fireplaces of the community.

Once again, Bannister has elevated a seemingly mundane job into one of integrity and purpose. This is a beauty filled landscape that is vast with a distant **horizon**. There is a hint of a town on the horizon.

• TEACHER NOTE

The American Barbizon School focused on painting simple, pastoral landscapes. They sought to keep imagery and colors realistic and to elevate the status of rural life. It was begun in America by William Morris Hunt after he studied in Barbizon, France, with Jean-François Millet and Rosa Bonheur.

• VOCABULARY

Linear Perspective: A way of drawing on a two-dimensional surface that portrays the correct depth, width, and height of an object.

Atmospheric Perspective: is the tool artists use to portray depth on a flat surface. Objects are more detailed, vivid & warmer in color and larger in the foreground, which communicates that these objects are closest to the viewer. As your eye moves "into" the artwork, through the middle ground and into the background, things become smaller, less detailed, almost blurry, and bluer/cooler in color.

∞ Video Link: What is Atmospheric Perspective?

Horizon: In art, this is the line that is created when the sky meets the ground. Objects grow hazier and smaller as they move closer to the horizon line.

∞ Video Link: Horizon Line

Picture Study

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 6 20m Picture Study - Lesson 6

Memory Drawing - Chalk

- Materials: Chalk and Chalkboard
- Art Print Resource: *Untitled (Landscape, Woodcutter on Path)*

→ MEMORY DRAWING

Focusing on the main lines, not detail, texture, color, or shading, draw the painting from memory. Use chalk on its side and draw in mass.

→ EVALUATE

When finished, take out the print and compare it to your own work. Did you include the main architectural, landscape, and/or human features?
∞ Link: *Untitled (Landscape, Woodcutter on Path)*

WEEK 7 20m Picture Study - Lesson 7

Picture Talk: *Edward Mitchell Bannister*

- Art Print Resource: *Newport*
- Vocabulary: Movement, Horizon, Middle Ground

→ STUDY

Look at art quietly for a few minutes; study the work as a whole, then begin to observe details.
∞ Link: *Newport*

→ NARRATE

Still looking at the art, tell all that you notice. Look and listen while others narrate.

→ PICTURE TALK

Discuss using questions to strengthen observational skills.

- Discuss everything you see in this landscape.
- Name and discuss the colors in this painting.
- Where do you see contour lines? How do they add **movement** in the painting?

→ PICTURE INFORMATION

In *Newport*, we observe a rough sea, pounding upon a rocky shore. Off in the far distance, a lighthouse breaks through the **horizon**. A few buildings dot the **middle ground** of the painting. These buildings are rendered in the traditional colors of the New England region of the United States of America. The expanse of the sky takes up almost half of the painting.

Bannister adds movement in his crashing waves with **contour lines** varying in color. The color changes of the water show the reflection of the sun in some areas and also how the water changes from deep to shallow against the rocks.

• VOCABULARY

Movement: is a way the artist causes the viewer's eye to move across their artwork and/or the illusion of action within the artwork.

∞ **Video Link:** The Art of Seeing Art: Movement

Horizon: In art, this is the line that is created when the sky meets the ground. Objects grow hazier and smaller as they move closer to the horizon line.

Middle Ground: is the section of an artwork that is across the middle of the artwork.

∞ **Video Link:** Middle Ground

Contour Lines: are lines that are created in the direction of an object in order to further describe that object. The lines will be rounded if they are describing a rounded surface, or may go horizontal and/or vertical if describing a flat surface, and diagonal if describing a surface that fades into space.

∞ **Video Link:** Contour Lines

WEEK 8 20m Picture Study - Lesson 8

Memory Drawing - Chalk

- Materials: Chalk and Chalkboard
- Art Print Resource: *Newport*

→ MEMORY DRAWING

Focusing on main lines, not detail, texture, color, or shading, draw the painting from memory. Use chalk on its side and draw in mass.

→ EVALUATE

Picture Study

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

When finished, take out the print and compare it to your own work. Did you include the main architectural, landscape, and/or human features?
∞ Link: *Newport*

WEEK 9 20m Picture Study - Lesson 9

Picture Talk: *Edward Mitchell Bannister*

🖨 Art Print Resource: *Fisherman by Water*
Vocabulary: Foreground, Earth Tones

→ STUDY

Look at the art quietly for a few minutes; study the work as a whole, then begin to observe details.
∞ Link: *Fisherman by Water*

→ NARRATE

Still looking at the art, tell all that you notice. Look and listen while others narrate.

→ PICTURE TALK

Discuss using questions to strengthen observational skills.

1. Discuss everything you see in this landscape.
2. Is the fisherman walking away from the or towards the water? What do you see that makes you think that?
3. Where is the artist standing while painting? How does this answer inform or change your last answer?
4. What do you think the pile of sticks is from in the **foreground**?

→ PICTURE INFORMATION

Edward Mitchell Bannister was living and working in Providence, Rhode Island, by this time in his career. He enjoyed being close to the water and using the scenes as inspiration for his art. *Fisherman by Water* shows a scene that would be an everyday occurrence in this part of the world.

The red band around the piece of wood in the **foreground** pops out against the natural, **earth tones** of the rest of the painting. It seems to add suspense in the painting. What is it? Where did it come from? Is this fisherman about to make an archeological discovery? That is left up to the imagination of the viewer!

• VOCABULARY

Foreground: is the section of an artwork bordering the bottom edge of the artwork.

∞ **Video Link:** Foreground

Earth Tones: are colors that resemble the colors found in nature, such as sky blue, pine green, cedar brown, ochre, etc.

WEEK 10 20m Picture Study - Lesson 10

Picture Talk: *Art Evolution*

🖨 Materials: Term's art prints

→ STUDY

Place prints out so that students can observe them all at one time.

→ NARRATE

Still looking at the art, tell all you that notice. Look and listen while others narrate.

→ PICTURE TALK

Look at the features in each print. Is there a style that is common to all of Edward Mitchell Bannister's work that we have studied? Discuss similarities and differences.

∞ Link: *Dorchester 1856*

∞ Link: *Newspaper Boy*

∞ Link: *Untitled (Landscape, Woodcutter on Path)*

∞ Link: *Newport*

∞ Link: *Fisherman By Water*

Picture Study

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 11 20m Picture Study - Lesson 11

Picture Talk: *Edward Mitchell Bannister*

Art Print Resource: *Boston Street Scene (Boston Common)*
Vocabulary: Color Palette, Impressionism, Linear Perspective, Atmospheric Perspective

→ STUDY

Look at the art quietly for a few minutes; study the work as a whole, then begin to observe details.

∞ Link: *Boston Street Scene (Boston Common)*

→ NARRATE

Still looking at the art, tell all that you notice. Look and listen while others narrate.

→ PICTURE TALK

Discuss using questions to strengthen observational skills.

1. Tell all that you observe in *Boston Street Scene (Boston Common)*.
2. What colors do you see in this painting? How are they similar to or different from Bannister's other paintings that you have studied?
3. Discuss all of the ways you see the skill of perspective applied in Bannister's painting.
4. Can you name other artists who were working in the Impressionistic style in the 1890s?

→ PICTURE INFORMATION

Boston Street Scene (Boston Common) was done very late in Bannister's career. We see a very different piece of art from the first one we studied. He has developed in his **color palette**, abandoning the earlier colors of realism for a more painterly palette of pastels. He has now adopted the impressionistic style. This may simply be because he wanted to try something new, or could have been in direct response to realism going out of style and **impressionism** being the sought-after work of the day. By the end of the late 1800s, into the early 1900s, city life was dominating the art scene.

A sophisticated understanding of **linear and atmospheric perspective** is displayed in this street scene. Bannister cleverly uses the street to invite his viewers into his painting at the bottom, left corner. The buildings and other objects grow smaller and more blurry as they move into the distance as well. The sides of the street seem to converge as they move away from the viewer.

Bannister's love of rendering vast landscapes speckled with the work of common man has been replaced with the rendering of cramped, close quarters of the city. The sky is still seen, but no longer does it take up half of the canvas.

• VOCABULARY

Color Palette: is a term used to refer to the colors an artist has chosen to paint or design with.

∞ **Video Link:** Color Palette (start at 11:57 and stop when you are understanding)

Impressionism: was a radical 19th-century art movement originating in France (circa 1874) that revolutionized painting by abandoning traditional, detailed studio work for spontaneous, plein air (outdoor) scenes. It is characterized by short, visible brushstrokes, bright colors, and an emphasis on capturing the fleeting, changing effects of light, movement, and modern life. (Metropolitan Museum of Art)
∞ **Video Link:** Impressionism

Linear Perspective: A way of drawing on a two-dimensional surface that portrays the correct depth, width, and height of an object.

Atmospheric Perspective: is the tool artists use to portray depth on a flat surface. Objects are more detailed, vivid & warmer in color and larger in the foreground, which communicates that these objects are closest to the viewer. As your eye moves "into" the artwork, through the middle ground and into the background, things become smaller, less detailed, almost blurry, and bluer/cooler in color.

WEEK 12 20m Picture Study - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from: Picture Study

Picture Study

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1 20m Picture Study - Lesson 13

Picture Talk: Liliás Trotter

Art Print Resource: *Riverbed Near Biskra*
Vocabulary: Atmospheric Perspective, Horizon, Texture, Foreground, Vanishing Point

→ STUDY

Look at the art quietly for a few minutes; study the work as a whole, then begin to observe details.

∞ Link: *Riverbed Near Biskra*

→ NARRATE

Still looking at the art, tell all that you notice. Look and listen while others narrate.

→ PICTURE TALK

Liliás Trotter is an artist who was lost to history for a century. She lived and worked in the mid 1800s through the early 1900s. Liliás gave up the possibility of becoming famous for her art to follow God's call of being a missionary to Northern Africa.

Discuss using questions to strengthen observational skills. Share about the artist's life as opportunities arise.

∞ Link: Liliás Trotter Bio

∞ Link: Interview with Miriam Rockness

1. Discuss everything you see in this landscape.
2. Talk about where you may have observed a scene like this before in your own life.
3. What are the people doing in the bottom, right corner?

→ PICTURE INFORMATION

This is one of many scenes Ms. Trotter would have encountered in northern Africa. She was drawn to the image of the shepherd with his sheep. She left many writings discussing Jesus as the Shepherd.

Liliás was skilled in portraying vast expanses by applying the rules of **perspective**. We see the **horizon** line and know that it is way off in the distance because things become smaller the closer they get to it. Objects become more blue, dull, and less detailed as well.

You can see the folds in the shepherd's fabric as well as the shadow his staff is casting over his back. We can also see some **texture** in the **foreground**. These clues tell us these objects are closer to us.

The hill to the right of the painting covers over the **vanishing point**, but it is clear that the point would be to the extreme right on the **horizon** lines because all lines tend to converge in that area.

• VOCABULARY

Atmospheric perspective: is the tool artists use to portray depth on a flat surface. Objects are more detailed, vivid & warmer in color and larger in the foreground, which communicates that these objects are closest to the viewer. As your eye moves "into" the artwork, through the middle ground and into the background, things become smaller, less detailed, almost blurry, and bluer/cooler in color.

Horizon: In art, this is the line that is created when the sky meets the ground. Objects grow hazier and smaller as they move closer to the horizon line.

Texture: could be actual- it appears bumpy, and you touch it and it's actually bumpy, or implied- it appears bumpy, but when you touch it, it is actually smooth.

∞ Video Link: Texture

Foreground: is the section of an artwork bordering the bottom edge of the artwork.

Vanishing Point: is the point on the horizon where, as objects get closer to it, they become smaller until they seem to disappear, and all lines seem to converge at that point as well.

∞ Video Link: Vanishing Point

WEEK 2 20m Picture Study - Lesson 14

Picture Talk: Liliás Trotter

Materials: chalk and chalkboard
Art Print Resource: *Riverbed Near Biskra*

→ MEMORY DRAWING

Focusing on the main lines, not the details, the texture, color, or shading, draw the painting from memory. Use chalk on its side and draw in mass.

→ EVALUATE

When finished, take out the print and compare it to your own work. Did you include the main architectural, landscape, and/or human features?



Term 2

∞ Link: *Riverbed Near Biskra*

→ PICTURE TALK

If time allows, read more on the artist in her bio or watch more of the interview with Miriam Rockness.

∞ Link: Liliás Trotter Bio

∞ Link: Interview with Miriam Rockness

WEEK 3 20m Picture Study - Lesson 15

Picture Talk: Liliás Trotter

 Art Print Resource: *Blue Blossoms*

→ STUDY

Look at art quietly for a few minutes; study the work as a whole, then begin to observe details.

∞ Link: *Blue Blossoms*

→ NARRATE

Still looking at the art, tell all that you notice. Look and listen while others narrate.

→ PICTURE TALK

Discuss using questions to strengthen observational skills. Share about the artist's life as opportunities arise.

∞ Link: Liliás Trotter Bio

∞ Link: Interview with Miriam Rockness

1. Describe what you see in this painting.
2. What shapes do you see in this painting? (answer: circles, ellipses, hearts, ovals)
3. Describe the lines that you see and tell what they represent in the painting.

→ PICTURE INFORMATION

Liliás enjoyed spending time in God's wonderful Creation. She documented the beauty she encountered, from the vast landscapes down to the minute weeds. She desired to learn the lessons of the Creator through everything He made.

This is a patch of blue-purple flowers that seem similar to a dandelion or bachelor button (aka cornflower). We do not know exactly what they are because Ms. Trotter did not document information in words, only this painting. Interestingly, three stems are growing from the same place, with the tallest having three flowers blooming in triangular form. Also, the three leaves are heart-shaped. This beautiful flower is blossoming out of a dark patch in the ground.

WEEK 4 20m Picture Study - Lesson 16

Picture Talk: Liliás Trotter

 Materials: chalk and chalkboard
 Art Print Resource: *Blue Blossoms*

→ MEMORY DRAWING

Focusing on the main lines, not the detail, texture, color, or shading, draw the painting from memory. Use chalk on its side and draw in mass.

→ EVALUATE

When finished, take out the print and compare it to your own work. Did you include the main architectural, landscape, and/or human features?

∞ Link: *Blue Blossoms*



Term 2

→ PICTURE TALK

If time allows, read more on the artist in her bio or watch more of the interview with Miriam Rockness.

∞ Link: Lilius Trotter Bio

∞ Link: Interview with Miriam Rockness

WEEK 5 20m Picture Study - Lesson 17

Picture Talk: Lilius Trotter

📄 Art Print Resource: *Mountain Flowers*

Vocabulary: Movement, Composition, Contour Lines, Value, Texture

→ STUDY

Look at the art quietly for a few minutes; study the work as a whole, then begin to observe details.

∞ Link: *Mountain Flowers*

→ NARRATE

Still looking at the art, tell all that you notice. Look and listen while others narrate.

→ PICTURE TALK

Discuss using questions to strengthen observational skills. Share about the artist's life as opportunities arise.

∞ Link: Lilius Trotter Bio

∞ Link: Interview with Miriam Rockness

1. Describe what you see in this painting.
2. In our last painting, *Blue Blossoms*, we noted that the lines used were describing the stem and petals of the flowers. In *Mountain Flowers*, describe the lines that you see and what they represent in this painting. Are these lines wavy, straight, vertical, horizontal, diagonal, etc.?
3. How many different types of flowers do you see, and how can you tell they are different from each other?
4. What type of brushstrokes does Lilius Trotter use to describe the surface texture of the rocks? Is this texture actual or implied?

→ PICTURE INFORMATION

Lilius Trotter must have been sitting on the side of a rocky mountain when this scene captured her interest. It's quite stunning that such beautiful and varied flowers can grow out of rock!

Notice the lines of **movement** Lilius has placed across her painting. These lines guide our eye from the top of the **composition** to the bottom, from left to right, or from right to left. They are not straight lines but wavy. We can see that the rocks are bumpy but seem to have been smoothed round by time due to Lilius Trotter's use of rounded lines to describe the **contour** of the rocks. We know they are not completely smooth due to her use of short, choppy lines of various **values** that communicate the undulations and uneven surface of the rock. These are the places the flowers protrude from. This **texture** is implied to the viewer- we can see what the texture looks like in the painting and imagine what it might feel like, but we cannot actually touch the rocky texture.

• VOCABULARY

Movement: is a way the artist causes the viewer's eye to move across their artwork and/or the illusion of action within the artwork.

Composition: refers to the way the artist sets up artwork using the elements and principles of art.

∞ **Video Link:** Composition

Contour Lines: are lines that are created in the direction of an object to further describe that object. The lines will be rounded if they are describing a rounded surface, or may go horizontal and/or vertical if describing a flat surface, and diagonal if describing a surface that fades into space.

Value: is the lightness or darkness of a color.

∞ **Video Link:** Value

Texture: could be actual- it appears bumpy, and you touch it, and it's actually bumpy, or implied- it appears bumpy, but when you touch it, it is actually smooth.

WEEK 6 20m Picture Study - Lesson 18

Picture Talk: Lilius Trotter

📄 Materials: chalk and chalkboard

📄 Art Print Resource: *Mountain Flowers*

→ MEMORY DRAWING

Focusing on the main lines, not the detail, texture, color, or shading, draw



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the painting from memory. Use chalk on its side and draw in mass.

→ EVALUATE

When finished, take out the print and compare it to your own work. Did you include the main architectural, landscape, and/or human features?

∞ Link: *Mountain Flowers*

→ PICTURE TALK

If time allows, read more on the artist in her bio or watch more of the interview with Miriam Rockness.

∞ Link: Liliat Trotter Bio

∞ Link: Interview with Miriam Rockness

WEEK 7 20m Picture Study - Lesson 19

Picture Talk: Liliat Trotter

 Art Print Resource: *Hand Woven Hangings*
Vocabulary: Composition, Foreground

→ STUDY

Look at the art quietly for a few minutes; study the work as a whole, then begin to observe details.

∞ Link: *Hand Woven Hangings*

→ NARRATE

Still looking at the art, tell all that you notice. Look and listen while others narrate.

→ PICTURE TALK

Discuss using questions to strengthen observational skills. Share about the artist's life as opportunities arise.

∞ Link: Liliat Trotter Bio

∞ Link: Interview with Miriam Rockness

1. Describe everything you see in this painting.
2. Discuss Trotter's use of perspective in this painting.
3. What effect do you think the colors of the fabrics have on the rest of the scene?

→ PICTURE INFORMATION

Liliat Trotter had a huge heart for the people she served in Algiers. She didn't just live amongst them with a desire to change them. She desired to know them. She wanted to know what inspired them. The best way to get to know anybody or anything is to spend time studying them in all their ways.

In this painting, we see Liliat studying the home of the people. This is the inner sanctum where they did life. We see steps leading up to a second level, which we may imagine is where they sleep. We see a stool in the lower right corner. We see laundry hanging on a clothesline stretched across the composition.

As before, we see many lines moving across this **composition**. Liliat Trotter was a master at moving the viewer through her artwork. There are strong, vertical lines, telling us not to miss the opening in the ceiling, nor the fact that this space is not one-story. The line of the wall meeting the flower moves diagonally across the **foreground** of the painting, with the stool following in parallel to it. This line moves us from the doorway on the right into the space and communicates that there is still more space beyond the painting that we are unable to see.

Her shadows under and to the left of every rim and edge are deep,

• VOCABULARY

Composition: refers to the way the artist sets up an artwork using the elements and principles of art.

Foreground: is the section of an artwork bordering the bottom edge of the artwork.

Light source: points to where the light is coming from, whether by the sun or artificial light- where it is coming from and how it is streaming across an object. Highlights, low lights, and shadows are all affected by the light source in an artwork. These aspects must be consistent within any given artwork to make a composition believable.

∞ **Video Link:** Light Source



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explaining to the viewer that the **light source** is coming from above and to the right. Perhaps Liliás is purposely sitting in a corner to the left, well away from the light pouring in, to cool off from the hot desert sun.

WEEK 8 20m Picture Study - Lesson 20

Picture Talk: Liliás Trotter

🖨️ Art Print Resource: *Hand Woven Hangings*

→ INTRO

Look at *Hand Woven Hangings*. Look at the lines. Discuss the types of lines that you see throughout the painting and what they depict. For example, what does the diagonal line in the middle of the painting from the right to the left side depict? Hint: It's where the wall and floor meet.
∞ Link: *Hand Woven Hangings*

→ MEMORY DISCUSSION

Describe *Hand Woven Hangings* from memory. Do you remember seeing the shadows in this painting?

→ EVALUATE

Look at the print; how did you do?

→ PICTURE TALK

If time allows, read more on the artist in her bio or watch more of the interview with Miriam Rockness.
∞ Link: Liliás Trotter Bio
∞ Link: Interview with Miriam Rockness

WEEK 9 20m Picture Study - Lesson 21

Picture Talk: Liliás Trotter

🖨️ Art Print Resource: *Storyteller*
Vocabulary: Background, Composition, Variety

→ STUDY

Look at the art quietly for a few minutes; study the work as a whole, then begin to observe details.
∞ Link: *Storyteller*

→ NARRATE

Still looking at the art, tell all that you notice. Look and listen while others narrate.

→ PICTURE TALK

Discuss using questions to strengthen observational skills. Share about the artist's life as opportunities arise.
∞ Link: Liliás Trotter Bio
∞ Link: Interview with Miriam Rockness

1. Describe everything that you see in this painting.
2. Where do you see shadows in this painting? Where do you think the light is coming from?
3. How does Liliás Trotter cause the people to look as though they are grounded as opposed to floating?

→ PICTURE INFORMATION

Here is another example of Liliás Trotter documenting everything she is learning about the people of Algiers. Here she is showing the viewer how these people love to share their stories with each other. Liliás documents that this is a mixed group of men, women, and children. They do not travel without water, as we see the water jug between the woman sitting and the man standing.

• VOCABULARY

Background: is the section of an artwork usually bordering the top edge of the artwork, however sometimes the background can be just above the horizontal center of the picture plane.
∞ **Video Link:** Background

Composition: refers to the way the artist sets up their artwork using the elements and principles of art.

Variety: is a principle of design that artists use to create interest and complexity and to break up monotony in their artwork. This can be accomplished by using different colors, varying your line type or weight, altering proportions, etc.
∞ **Video Link:** Variety



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We do not know if the people are sitting inside a home or outside, but we can see the faint pencil outline of architectural features in the **background**. These are the traditional arched doorways of the land.

Lilias has shown her **composition** skills once again. There are various height differences between people. The one man is standing to the left of the painting. If we move from the top of his head down and toward the right, towards the toes of the child, we see a diagonal emerge. A few of the people in the painting are looking at the speaker. The one with his back to us is looking into the crowd, and there are two people looking toward the viewer. These differences create **variety** and interest, causing the viewer to want to study the people as well. The child is in a state of movement, causing the viewer to want to study him and to ask what he is playing.

While the majority of the people are wearing white, Lilias has made sure to add variety and interest again by adding touches of color, such as in the man's red hat, the woman's blue headdress, and the child's green clothing.

WEEK 10 20m Picture Study - Lesson 22

Picture Talk: Lilias Trotter

🖨️ Art Print Resource: *Storyteller*

→ MEMORY DISCUSSION

Describe the painting from memory. What are the people in the painting doing?

→ MEMORY EXERCISE

Choose one person in the painting and pose in the same position. Pay attention to your facial expression.

→ EVALUATE

When finished, take out the print and compare it to your own work. How did you do?

∞ Link: *Storyteller*

→ PICTURE TALK

If time allows, read more on the artist in her bio or watch more of the interview with Miriam Rockness.

∞ Link: Lilias Trotter Bio

∞ Link: Interview with Miriam Rockness

WEEK 11 20m Picture Study - Lesson 23

Picture Talk: Lilias Trotter

🖨️ Art Print Resource: *Moonlight*
Vocabulary: Atmospheric Perspective, Proportion, Foreground, Horizon, Linear Perspective, Composition, Texture

→ STUDY

Look at art quietly for a few minutes; study the work as a whole, then begin to observe details.

∞ Link: *Moonlight*

→ NARRATE

Still looking at the art, tell all that you notice. Look and listen while others narrate.

→ PICTURE TALK

Discuss using questions to strengthen observational skills. Share about the artist's life as opportunities arise.

• VOCABULARY

Atmospheric perspective: is the tool artists use to portray depth on a flat surface. Objects are more detailed, vivid & warmer in color and larger in the foreground, which communicates that these objects are closest to the viewer. As your eye moves "into" the artwork, through the middle ground and into the background, things become smaller, less detailed, almost blurry, and bluer/cooler in color.

Proportion: refers to the size relationship between objects; for example, your hand is smaller than a horse, and your ear is

Picture Study

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

- ∞ Link: Liliat Trotter Bio
- ∞ Link: Interview with Miriam Rockness

1. Describe everything you see in this painting.
2. Discuss the use of linear and atmospheric perspective in the painting.
3. Do you think the person is correctly proportioned? Why or why not?
4. What colors do you notice in the painting? How are they different from the first landscape, *Riverbed Near Biskra*, that we studied?

→ PICTURE INFORMATION

You can almost feel the relief on this day as the moon rises and the sun has set in the desert. Liliat Trotter shows her understanding of **atmospheric perspective** and also how to communicate heat in a painting. The mountains are in the distance. We know this because of their size **proportion** to the person walking in the **foreground**, but also because they are hazy. While atmospheric perspective does require that objects in the distance grow more hazy and bluer the closer to the **horizon** they are, rendering heat in a visual form causes things to become hazier before the perspective would set in. We are able to see the hot, heavy air by seeing that the mountains are almost invisible closer to us.

We see **linear perspective** as the road the traveler is on shoots diagonally towards the right of the **composition** and to the horizon line. We know that the person walking is closer to us than the mountains are, due to the size relationship. The person would continue growing larger as they walked closer to the bottom of the painting- the foreground. There is more detail in the **texture** in the foreground as we see blades of grass and shrubbery to the right. We are also able to make out the bundle of sticks on the traveler's back.

larger than an ant. Things farther away are smaller, while things closer to you are larger; for example, a chair right next to you will appear larger than a tree that is a half mile down the road.

∞ **Video Link:** Proportion

Foreground: is the section of an artwork bordering the bottom edge of the artwork.

Horizon: In art, this is the line that is created when the sky meets the ground. Objects grow hazier and smaller as they move closer to the horizon line.

Linear Perspective: A way of drawing on a two-dimensional surface that portrays the correct depth, width, and height of an object.

Composition: refers to the way the artist sets up an artwork using the elements and principles of art.

Texture: could be actual- it appears bumpy, and you touch it, and it's actually bumpy, or implied- it appears bumpy, but when you touch it, it is actually smooth.

WEEK 12 20m Picture Study - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from: Picture Study



Term 3

WEEK 1 □ 20m Picture Study - Lesson 25

Picture Talk: Vincent van Gogh

□ Art Print Resource: *Pollard Birches*

Vocabulary: Contour Lines, Linear Perspective, Atmospheric Perspective, Hatching, Cross-Hatching, Horizon, Middle Ground

→ STUDY

Look at art quietly for a few minutes; study the work as a whole, then begin to observe details.

∞ Link: *Pollard Birches*

→ NARRATE

Still looking at the art, tell all that you notice. Look and listen while others narrate.

→ PICTURE TALK

Vincent van Gogh is one of the most famous artists in the world though he sold only one painting during his lifetime and always regretted that sale. His work is known for its bold colors and lines as well as thick textures. Discuss using questions to strengthen observational skills.

1. Discuss all that you see in this artwork.
2. Where do you see lines that communicate movement in this drawing?
3. Can you point to areas in the art where you see hatching and cross-hatching being used? Are these lines used for shading or as contour lines?
4. Discuss all of the perspective techniques that Van Gogh uses in this artwork.

→ PICTURE INFORMATION

At the beginning of his art career, Vincent spent his time drawing. He drew everything he saw from careful observation. If you look closely at his work, you will see the **contour lines** that help to explain that the trees are rounded cylinders and the grass grows straight and vertical. You can also see the diagonal lines in the center of the trees, which lend to the concept of **perspective**. Later, we will see these same contour lines in his paintings.

Notice the knowledge and application of skill Van Gogh has in perspective. Not only does his use of **hatching** and **cross-hatching** describe the movement towards the **horizon** line, but so does the shape of the flock of sheep. We can tell that the Shepherd is further away from us than the woman. Even though both figures protrude over and under the horizon line, the man is smaller. The trees and clumps of grass also grow smaller as they move away from the viewer.

Van Gogh preferred to have a figure in his art in order to tell a story. In *Pollard Birches*, we see a shepherd with his flock of sheep to the right of the trees and a woman standing alone to the left of the trees. Nothing is happening in the columns of trees in the **middle ground**, and yet there is still so much energy due to the expressive lines Van Gogh used.

• VOCABULARY

Contour Lines: are lines that are created in the direction of an object in order to further describe that object. The lines will be rounded if they are describing a rounded surface, or may go horizontal and/or vertical if describing a flat surface, and diagonal if describing a surface that fades into space.

Linear Perspective: A way of drawing on a two-dimensional surface that portrays the correct depth, width, and height of an object.

Atmospheric Perspective: is the tool artists use to portray depth on a flat surface. Objects are more detailed, vivid & warmer in color and larger in the foreground, which communicates that these objects are closest to the viewer. As your eye moves "into" the artwork, through the middle ground and into the background, things become smaller, less detailed, almost blurry, and bluer/cooler in color.

Hatching: is a method of applying value to artwork using parallel lines. When lines are created closer together, they result in a darker value, and when they are created further apart, they result in a lighter value.

∞ Video Link: Hatching

Cross-hatching: is very similar to hatching except for the lines layer over each other in an x pattern.

∞ Video Link: Cross-hatching

Horizon: In art, this is the line that is created when the sky meets the ground. Objects grow hazier and smaller as they move closer to the horizon line.

Middle Ground: is the section of an artwork that is across the middle of the artwork.

Picture Study

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 2 20m Picture Study - Lesson 26

Memory Drawing - Chalk

- Materials: Chalk and Chalkboard
- Art Print Resource: *Pollard Birches*

→ MEMORY DRAWING

Focusing on main lines, not detail, texture, color, or shading, draw the painting from memory. Use chalk on its side and draw in mass.

→ EVALUATE

When finished, take out the print and compare it to your own work. Did you include the main architectural, landscape, and/or human features?
∞ Link: *Pollard Birches*

→ PICTURE TALK

If time allows, read about the artist in his bio.
∞ Link: Vincent Van Gogh Bio

WEEK 3 20m Picture Study - Lesson 27

Picture Talk: Vincent van Gogh

- Art Print Resource: *The Potato Eaters*
- Vocabulary: Chiaroscuro Effect, Monochromatic

→ STUDY

Look at art quietly for a few minutes; study the work as a whole, then begin to observe details.
∞ Link: *The Potato Eaters*

→ NARRATE

Still looking at art, tell all you notice. Look and listen while others narrate.

→ PICTURE TALK

Discuss using questions to strengthen observational skills.

1. Discuss what you see in this painting. What is happening?
2. Talk about where you may have observed a scene like this before in your own life.
3. What artistic techniques can you think of that Van Gogh used in his painting to describe action?

→ PICTURE INFORMATION

Vincent van Gogh completed *The Potato Eaters* while studying painting in Holland. He was still focused on trying to render normal people doing everyday things. These people are hard workers. They have put in the labor to plant, grow, and harvest the potatoes that they are now sharing as a meal.

Van Gogh stays true to the realism genre in the use of a neutral, toned-down palette of greys and browns. He is also using the **chiaroscuro effect** in his choice to render the light coming from one single source and offering a great illuminating effect on the people and walls in the room. His palette also has a sense of being **monochrome**. You could say it is painted in several different values of one color.

The characters in his artwork are full of action, and though they are interacting with one another by means of service, they are not interacting by means of communication. None of them makes eye contact with each other.

The lines in *The Potato Eaters* are dark and harsh. Van Gogh created the

• VOCABULARY

Chiaroscuro effect: is when there is a single light source in a work of art, and the contrast between light and dark is significant. This creates volume and three-dimensionality on a flat surface. It also causes a scene to be more dramatic in flair.

∞ Video Link: Chiaroscuro

Monochromatic: is a term used to describe various values of one color. Mono means one. Chroma means color.

∞ Video Link: Monochromatic



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faces of the peasants, also dark and harsh. He also used lines to describe the three-dimensionality of the room on a flat surface. We see that the table is rendered in perspective as the roof rafters at the top of the canvas.

WEEK 4 20m Picture Study - Lesson 28

Picture Talk: Vincent van Gogh

- 📄 Materials: props and costumes resembling *The Potato Eaters*
- 📄 Art Print Resource: *The Potato Eaters*

→ MEMORY ACTIVITY

Create a tableau vivant of *The Potato Eaters* with your fellow students. (A tableau vivant, French for "living picture," is where a group of actors recreate a painting with costumes and props and sitting still in the same poses.) Collect props and costumes and choose your pose without looking at the painting.

→ EVALUATE

When finished, take out the print and compare it to your tableau vivant. How did you do?
∞ Link: *The Potato Eaters*

→ PICTURE TALK

If time allows, read more on the artist in his bio.
∞ Link: Vincent van Gogh Bio

WEEK 5 20m Picture Study - Lesson 29

Picture Talk: Vincent van Gogh

- 📄 Art Print Resource: *Still Life with Decanter and Lemons on a Plate*
- Vocabulary: Contour Lines, Hatching, Cross-Hatching, Horizon, Movement

→ STUDY

Look at art quietly for a few minutes; study the work as a whole, then begin to observe details.
∞ Link: *Still Life with Decanter and Lemons on a Plate*

→ NARRATE

Still looking at the art, tell all you notice. Look and listen while others narrate.

→ PICTURE TALK

Discuss using questions to strengthen observational skills.

1. Discuss what you see in this painting.
2. What colors do you see? Are there primary, secondary, or tertiary colors in this painting? Describe where there are warm and cool colors and complementary colors.
3. Does Vincent van Gogh achieve a sense of depth in this painting? Why or why not?

→ PICTURE INFORMATION

Still Life with Decanter and Lemons on a Plate was painted after Vincent left Holland to move in with his brother, Theo, in Paris. Moving to Paris had a huge effect on Van Gogh's color choice. He met many other artists while he was there and came in contact with the art of even more artists than he met. He attended an art academy for a few months and saw new and exciting scenes that were different from the life he had left. All of these things had an effect on his paintings.

• VOCABULARY

Contour Lines: are lines that are created in the direction of an object to further describe that object. The lines will be rounded if they are describing a rounded surface, or may go horizontal and/or vertical if describing a flat surface, and diagonal if describing a surface that fades into space.

Hatching: is a method of applying value to an artwork using parallel lines. When lines are created closer together, they result in a darker value, and when they are created further apart, they result in a lighter value.

Cross-hatching: is very similar to hatching except for the lines layer over each other in an X pattern.

Movement: is a way the artist causes the viewer's eye to move across their artwork and/or the illusion of action within the artwork.

Horizon: In art, this is the line that is created when the sky meets the ground. Objects grow hazier and smaller as they move closer to the horizon line.



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Vincent took all that he saw of trends in the art world and happenings around him and condensed it all into his very own style. Many art dealers and successful artists became offended as they saw their influence on this world become altered in Van Gogh's work.

At this time in his career, he no longer took the time to draw and sketch subjects before painting them. Instead, he drew right onto the canvas with brush and paint. This is where we see a similar style to when he was drawing with ink. He uses **contour lines**, **hatching**, and **cross-hatching** to add **movement** and to describe objects in his art.

In *Still Life with Decanter and Lemons on a Plate*, he did use these lines, but instead of using round lines to describe a round bottle, he used straight horizontal and vertical lines, and instead of using diagonal lines to describe the table moving back into space, he used rounded lines. This choice causes the bottle to seem flat and the table to seem as though it is falling into the foreground. The plate almost appears to be falling over with the lemons tumbling off! Regardless, we can see that Vincent intended movement as opposed to stagnation in this painting.

WEEK 6 20m Picture Study - Lesson 30

Memory Drawing - Chalk

- ▢ Materials: Chalk and Chalkboard
- ▢ Art Print Resource: *Still Life with Decanter and Lemons on a Plate*

→ MEMORY DRAWING

Focusing on main lines, not detail, texture, color or shading, draw the painting from memory. Use chalk on its side and draw in mass.

→ EVALUATE

When finished, take out the print and compare it to your own work. Did you include the main architectural, landscape, and/or human features?

∞ Link: *Still Life with Decanter and Lemons on a Plate*

→ PICTURE TALK

If time allows, read more on the artist in his bio.

∞ Link: Vincent van Gogh Bio

WEEK 7 20m Picture Study - Lesson 31

Picture Talk: Vincent van Gogh

- ▢ Art Print Resource: *The Harvest*
- Vocabulary: En Plein Air, Color Scheme, Complementary Colors, Analogous Colors, Color Wheel, Balance, Atmospheric Perspective, Proportion, Foreground, Middle Ground, Space, Texture

→ STUDY

Look at the art quietly for a few minutes; study the work as a whole, then begin to observe details.

∞ Link: *The Harvest*

→ NARRATE

Still looking at the art, tell all that you notice. Look and listen while others narrate.

→ PICTURE TALK

Discuss using questions to strengthen observational skills.

1. How many people do you see in this painting? What are they doing?
2. What types of plants can you make out?

• VOCABULARY

en plein aire: painting outdoors while looking at what you are painting.

∞ Video Link: en plein aire

Color Scheme: refers to the colors chosen for an artwork. This can also be called the palette.

∞ Video Link: Color Scheme

Complementary Colors: are colors directly across from each other on the color wheel.

Analogous Colors: are two to four colors next to each other on the color wheel.

Color Wheel: is a system of classifying colors in a circular format.



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3. Discuss a time when you may have seen a scene like this in your life.
4. What time period do you think this painting was made in? What are the clues that tell you?
5. Name the colors that you see. Hint: Use the full color wheel (12 colors).
6. Name pairs of complementary colors that you see and point to them.

→ PICTURE INFORMATION

The Harvest was painted **en plein air** during the time of the actual harvest. Van Gogh worked at a fever pitch to complete 15 works of art of the harvest in just over a week. He told his brother Theo that this was the best and his favorite, completed in that time.

In this painting, you can see the people working. We see ladders leaning against piles of wheat, farmers in the fields, horses pulling wagons, and fields that have been mown. It is a painting of people in the act of harvesting their crops.

The **color scheme** is roughly a **complementary** one stretching from orange to blue and incorporating the **analogous colors** in between on the **color wheel**. We see one bright red wagon on the right-hand side that pops off the canvas. It also adds a visual **balance** to the patch of darker green plants just below the center of the painting.

Van Gogh mastered the concept of **atmospheric perspective** and **proportion**. Notice how in the **foreground**, the yellow stalks of wheat are the same size as the larger seeming, green plants in the **middle ground** and almost as tall as the fence posts. They are also accentuated with red and blue in some areas, which denotes **space** between the stalks and shadows. We do not see the individual stalks of wheat in the back fields, only a few indications of overall **texture**. The fence posts are the same height as the farmer in the green plants and much larger than the two people in the path at the top, left, and center of the painting. The pile of wheat is towering in size over the mountains that are in the distance. The wagon in the center is much larger than the buildings closest to the mountains. All of these things give the feeling of depth and space. One may imagine that Van Gogh is perched on the rooftop of a two-story building overlooking this vast landscape.

Balance: refers to the visual weight of an artwork. Objects, colors, shapes, etc., within an artwork can have different weights, which can cause an artwork to either seem balanced or off balance.

∞ **Video Link:** Balance

Atmospheric Perspective: is the tool artists use to portray depth on a flat surface. Objects are more detailed, vivid & warmer in color and larger in the foreground, which communicates that these objects are closest to the viewer. As your eye moves “into” the artwork, through the middle ground and into the background, things become smaller, less detailed, almost blurry, and bluer/cooler in color.

Proportion: refers to the size relationship between objects; for example, your hand is smaller than a horse, and your ear is larger than an ant. Things farther away are smaller, while things closer to you are larger; for example, a chair right next to you will appear larger than a tree that is a half mile down the road.

Foreground: is the section of an artwork bordering the bottom edge of the artwork.

Middle Ground: is the section of an artwork that is across the middle of the artwork.

Space: can be either negative- the area around an object in artwork, or positive- the intended area of the object. It can also refer to the total area in an artwork.

∞ **Video Link:** Space

Texture: could be actual- it appears bumpy, and you touch it, and it's actually bumpy, or implied- it appears bumpy, but when you touch it, it is actually smooth.



Term 3

WEEK 8 20m Picture Study - Lesson 32

Memory Drawing - Chalk

- ☐ Materials: Chalk and Chalkboard
- ☐ Art Print Resource: *The Harvest*

→ MEMORY DRAWING

Focusing on main lines, not detail, texture, color or shading, draw the painting from memory. Use chalk on its side and draw in mass.

∞ Link: *The Harvest*

→ EVALUATE

When finished, take out the print and compare it to your own work. Did you include the main architectural, landscape, and/or human features?

→ PICTURE TALK

If time allows, read more on the artist in his bio.

∞ Link: Vincent van Gogh Bio

WEEK 9 20m Picture Study - Lesson 33

Picture Talk: Vincent van Gogh

- ☐ Art Print Resource: *The Starry Night*
- Vocabulary: Linear Perspective, Atmospheric Perspective, Balance

→ STUDY

Look at art quietly for a few minutes; study the work as a whole, then begin to observe details.

∞ Link: *The Starry Night*

→ NARRATE

Still looking at the art, tell all that you notice. Look and listen while others narrate.

→ PICTURE TALK

Discuss using questions to strengthen observational skills.

1. Discuss what you see in the painting.
2. What would you say is the “main character” in the painting and why?
3. Do you notice any people in the painting? Is Van Gogh still able to tell a story about people in this painting? What is that story?
4. Discuss the use of lines in *Starry Night*. What are they communicating to the viewer?

→ PICTURE INFORMATION

The Starry Night, also known as *Starry Night*, is one of the most famous, iconic paintings in the West. We are all familiar with the dancing cypress trees and pulsing stars in this painting.

Vincent painted in all seasons, all weather, and all times of the day. There was no situation outside that he would allow to stop him. He carried his canvases, easel, brushes, and paints into all situations of life.

In his letters to family and friends, he would discuss his attraction to each of these scenes. He described the stars with words in the same way he described them with paint- glowing, yellow orbs that seem to pulse. He said he could see the wind as it blew across the sky, causing grass and trees to sway.

He talked about cypress trees and their unique color to his brother, Theo.

• VOCABULARY

Linear Perspective: A way of drawing on a two-dimensional surface that portrays the correct depth, width, and height of an object.

Atmospheric Perspective: is the tool artists use to portray depth on a flat surface. Objects are more detailed, vivid & warmer in color, and larger in the foreground, which communicates that they are closest to the viewer. As your eye moves “into” the artwork, through the middle ground and into the background, things become smaller, less detailed, almost blurry, and bluer/cooler in color.

Balance: refers to the visual weight of an artwork. Objects, colors, shapes, etc., within an artwork can have different weights, which cause the artwork to either appear balanced or off balance.



Term 3

He stressed how he could not get a handle on their unique green with some black in their coloring. He spoke of the hours he spent watching the trees to understand their movement and the effect light had on the trees.

Vincent once again displays his understanding of **perspective** in *Starry Night*. We can tell that the cypress tree was the closest object to him and that he was looking down over a town that was receding into the distance. Notice how the buildings that are closer to the bottom of the painting are larger, and they grow smaller as they move up the canvas. Notice how the cypress tree is larger than the mountains. This communicates that they are further away as well.

Notice more than anything that Vincent wanted the viewer to pay attention to the beauty in the night sky. The sky takes up over three-fourths of the painting! The size and brightness of the moon in the top right corner can **balance** out the heaviness of the dark, large cypress tree in the foreground to the left.

While *Starry Night* was painted a little more than a year before Van Gogh's death, it was not even close to being one of his last paintings. He painted hundreds more in the next 13 months!

WEEK 10 20m Picture Study - Lesson 34

Picture Talk: Art Evolution

- ▢ Materials: Term's art prints
- ▢ Art Print Resource: *Pollard Birches*
- ▢ Art Print Resource: *The Potato Eaters*
- ▢ Art Print Resource: *Still Life with Decanter and Lemons on a Plate*
- ▢ Art Print Resource: *The Harvest*
- ▢ Art Print Resource: *The Starry Night*

→ STUDY

Place prints out so that students can observe them all at one time.

→ NARRATE

Still looking at art, tell all you notice. Look and listen while others narrate.

→ PICTURE TALK

Look at the features in each print. Is there a style that is common amongst all of Vincent van Gogh's work that we have studied? Discuss similarities and differences.

WEEK 11 20m Picture Study - Lesson 35

Picture Talk: Vincent van Gogh

- ▢ Art Print Resource: *The Church at Auvers*
- Vocabulary: Foreground

→ STUDY

Look at art quietly for a few minutes; study the work as a whole, then begin to observe details.

∞ Link: *The Church at Auvers*

→ NARRATE

Still looking at the art, tell all that you notice. Look and listen while others narrate.

→ PICTURE TALK

Discuss using questions to strengthen observational skills.

1. Discuss all that you see in this painting.

• VOCABULARY

Foreground: is the section of an artwork bordering the bottom edge of the artwork.



Term 3

2. What colors stand out to you?
3. Describe where the horizon line is in this painting.
4. Does van Gogh's use of lines help or hinder the depth in this painting? Explain.

→ PICTURE INFORMATION

Auvers, France, is the last place Vincent van Gogh lived. As was his custom wherever he was, he spent much time outdoors walking and exploring his surroundings. He used those surroundings as subjects for his paintings to communicate his feelings about the place.

In 1890, Vincent began pondering heavily his Christian upbringing and the ever presence of God. He began copying religious paintings of other artists, such as Delacroix, Rembrandt, etc., but rendering them in his own style.

He wrote many letters to his family describing the church at Auvers. He was particularly fond of the architecture of the building and the brilliance of the stained glass. He described the stained glass as the most brilliant ultramarine color he had ever seen. He discussed the colors of the dirt around Auvers, describing it in some places as a sunburnt pink tan.

In *The Church at Auvers*, we see these descriptions played out. We also see a path that forks around the church and a woman walking away from us on one of those paths. The sky seems ominous, as if there is a storm moving in. We can see smaller buildings beyond the church, but the church is the main object in the painting. It sprawls out in the center, casting a shadow in the **foreground**.

While van Gogh created this painting in June and died a month later, this still was not one of his last paintings!

WEEK 12 20m Picture Study - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from: Picture Study

Picture Study

Examination

Term 1

- (GRADE 1-12) Describe your favorite art piece from Edward Mitchell Bannister. Give as much detail as you can. OR Do a memory drawing of your favorite piece of art from Edward Mitchell Bannister.
- (GRADE 9-12) What stood out to you in Redeeming Vision and why? If you did not read Redeeming Vision, then what stood out to you about Edward Mitchell Bannister in his biography and picture information that has been provided throughout the lessons this term, and why?

Term 2

- (GRADE 1-12) Describe your favorite art piece from Liliias Trotter. Give as much detail as you can. OR Do a memory drawing of your favorite piece of art from Liliias Trotter.
- (GRADE 9-12) What stood out to you in A Passion For the Impossible and why? If you did not read A Passion for the Impossible, then what stood out to you in Liliias Trotter's biography and picture information that has been provided throughout the lessons this term, and why?

Term 3

- (GRADE 1-12) Describe your favorite art piece from Vincent van Gogh. Give as much detail as you can. OR Do a memory drawing of your favorite piece of art from Vincent van Gogh.
- (GRADE 9-12) What stood out to you in Van Gogh's biography and why? If you did not read the optional biography, then what stood out to you in Van Gogh's biography and picture information that has been provided throughout the lessons this term, and why?